Content-capacity contract

Count first, then choose.

Every layout declares how many elements it holds — so you pick by content shape, and the linter warns before an overflow.

The slip that causes overflow.

Pick by intent only

The agent matches the topic to a layout's tags and skeleton, never counting how many elements the content actually has.

Pour in too much

Eight items land in a grid built for three or four; the slide silently overflows its frame.

Catch it too late

The red overflow ring only shows up at render — long after the layout was chosen.

A grid at its sweet spot.

Confidence

How sure are we the signal is real? Scored one to five each week.

Recency

How fresh is the signal? Decays as the data ages.

Relevance

How much does it move the strategy? Weighted by the team.

Too many? Escalate, don't cram.

01	**Confidence — is the signal real?**	Scored one to five every week.
02	**Recency — how fresh is it?**	Decays as the data ages.
03	**Relevance — does it move strategy?**	Weighted by the team and reviewed quarterly.
04	**Coverage — how complete is intake?**	Tracked against the source checklist.
05	**Cost — what did it take to collect?**	Logged for the calibration loop.

The contract, in four numbers.

axis

THE COLLECTION THAT CROWDS — ITEM, ROW, COL, CELL OR LINE.

sweet

THE IDEAL COUNT, SURFACED TO THE AUTHOR.

soft

PAST HERE IT CROWDS — A SOFT WARNING FIRES.

hard

PAST HERE IT OVERFLOWS — THE LOUD WARNING FIRES.

The warning reads like a fix.

```
⚠ deck.md · slide 4 · capacity-overflow [cards-grid]
   'cards-grid' holds about 3 items comfortably (max ~5);
   this slide has 8 — it will overflow
   fix: Switch to list-tabular, or split across slides.
```

The author's loop.

STEP 01

Count

How many items, rows, columns, or code lines does the content have?

STEP 02

Check

Read the component's capacity in components.pick.md — sweet/soft/hard.

STEP 03

Choose

Within capacity, keep it; over hard, take an escalateTo target or split.

> *Pick the layout by shape, not by vibe — the number of elements decides it as much as the topic does.*

— THE CONTENT-CAPACITY CONTRACT